

London College of Music Examinations

Piano
2018–2020

Grade 7

Piano: Grade 7, Recital Grade 7 and Leisure Play Grade 7

This handbook is part of a progressive series of handbooks, primarily intended for candidates considering taking London College of Music examinations in piano. All candidates must bring their own copy of the relevant handbook to the exam. Candidates must also refer to the current syllabus.

Syllabus validity

This handbook is valid for examinations from Spring 2018 to Winter 2020.

Further information

To enter for an exam or view the current syllabus, please visit the LCM Examinations website:

lcme.uwl.ac.uk

Editorial guidance

Editorial input has been kept to a minimum in order to reproduce the composers' intentions as clearly as possible.

Editorial notes are available to download from the LCM Examinations website, detailing any additions.

Metronome markings and fingerings have been given as an aid to developing your own interpretations; they have been included for guidance and do not have to be followed in the exam.

The use of the sustaining pedal, particularly in the higher grades, has been taken for granted and only indicated when it is required for a specific effect. Unless specified, the pedal markings given are for guidance only, as the use of the pedal depends to a large extent on the characteristics of the piano, the acoustics of the room, and the interpretation of the piece.

Repeats

Performance of repeats is at the candidate's discretion. In general, repeats should be included, but longer repeats (for example, the full exposition of a sonata form movement) should not be played. Da Capo and Dal Segno signs must be observed.

Piano: Grade 7

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TECHNICAL WORK

SCALES AND ARPEGGIOS

REQUIREMENTS

- Scales
- Contrary motion scales
- Scales in thirds, hands separately
- Chromatic scale in minor thirds
- Contrary motion chromatic scales
- Arpeggios
- Dominant 7th arpeggios
- Diminished 7th arpeggios

Candidates should either prepare all of the following scales and arpeggios, or both studies (pages 22 and 24).

Scales and arpeggios are to be performed from memory, and *legato* unless otherwise specified.

Scales:

4 octaves

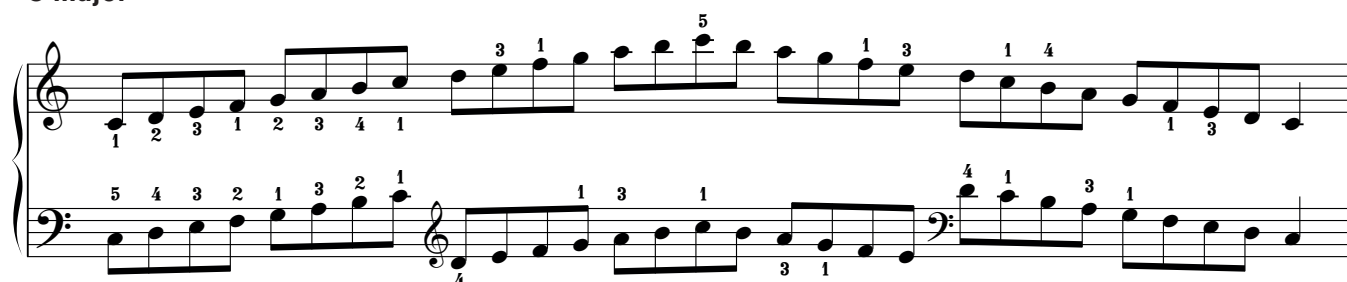
(2 octaves shown)

C, D, A, E, B, F[♯], F and D[♭] major

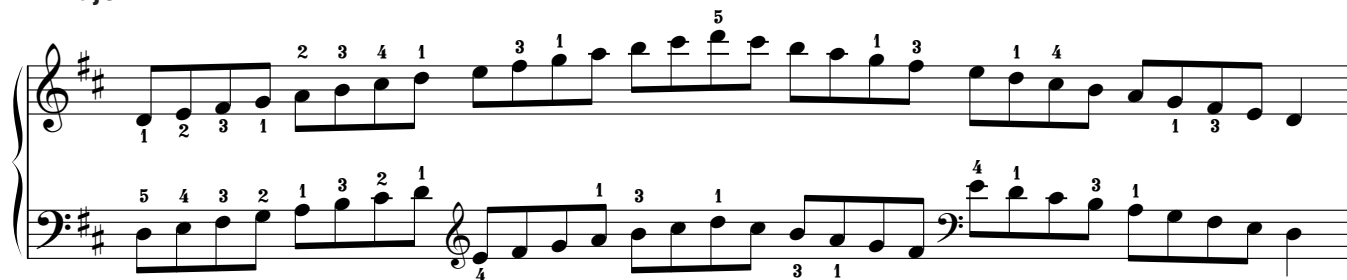
C, D, A, E, B, F[♯], F and C[♯] minor (harmonic and melodic)

- Hands separately and together
- *Piano* and *forte*, *legato* and *staccato*
- Recommended tempo: ♩ = 80

C major



D major



A major

Handwritten musical score for the A major scale. The treble clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 2 1. The bass clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 1 3 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1.

E major

Handwritten musical score for the E major scale. The treble clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 2 1. The bass clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 1 3 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1.

B major

Handwritten musical score for the B major scale. The treble clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 1 2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 2 1. The bass clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 1 3 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1.

F# major

Handwritten musical score for the F# major scale. The treble clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 1 2 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 2. The bass clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 1 3 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1.

F major

Handwritten musical score for the F major scale. The treble clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 1 2 3 4 1 2 3 1 2 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 1 2. The bass clef staff shows the ascending and descending scales with fingerings: 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 1 3 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1.

D $\flat$ major

Piano exercise for D $\flat$ major scale. The exercise is written for piano with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays the ascending scale, and the left hand plays the descending scale. The exercise is divided into two parts, each with a repeat sign. The first part covers the first two octaves, and the second part covers the next two octaves. Fingering numbers (1-5) are indicated above the notes.

C harmonic minor

Piano exercise for C harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays the ascending scale, and the left hand plays the descending scale. The exercise is divided into two parts, each with a repeat sign. The first part covers the first two octaves, and the second part covers the next two octaves. Fingering numbers (1-5) are indicated above the notes.

C melodic minor

Piano exercise for C melodic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays the ascending scale, and the left hand plays the descending scale. The exercise is divided into two parts, each with a repeat sign. The first part covers the first two octaves, and the second part covers the next two octaves. Fingering numbers (1-5) are indicated above the notes.

D harmonic minor

Piano exercise for D harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays the ascending scale, and the left hand plays the descending scale. The exercise is divided into two parts, each with a repeat sign. The first part covers the first two octaves, and the second part covers the next two octaves. Fingering numbers (1-5) are indicated above the notes.

D melodic minor

Piano exercise for D melodic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The right hand plays the ascending scale, and the left hand plays the descending scale. The exercise is divided into two parts, each with a repeat sign. The first part covers the first two octaves, and the second part covers the next two octaves. Fingering numbers (1-5) are indicated above the notes.

A harmonic minor

Ascending: A (1), B (2), C# (3), D (1), E (2), F# (3), G# (4), A (5).
Descending: G# (1), F# (2), E (3), D (4), C# (1), B (2), A (3).

A melodic minor

Ascending: A (1), B (2), C# (3), D (1), E (2), F# (3), G# (4), A (5).
Descending: G# (1), F# (2), E (3), D (4), C# (1), B (2), A (3).

E harmonic minor

Ascending: E (1), F# (2), G# (3), A (1), B (2), C# (3), D# (4), E (5).
Descending: D# (1), C# (2), B (3), A (4), G# (1), F# (2), E (3).

E melodic minor

Ascending: E (1), F# (2), G# (3), A (1), B (2), C# (3), D# (4), E (5).
Descending: D# (1), C# (2), B (3), A (4), G# (1), F# (2), E (3).

B harmonic minor

Ascending: B (1), C# (2), D# (3), E (1), F# (2), G# (3), A# (4), B (5).
Descending: A# (1), G# (2), F# (3), E (4), D# (1), C# (2), B (3).

B melodic minor

Two systems of musical notation for the B melodic minor scale. The first system shows the treble and bass staves with fingerings: Treble (1 2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1) and Bass (4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1). The second system continues the scale with fingerings: Treble (3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (3 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1).

F# harmonic minor

Two systems of musical notation for the F# harmonic minor scale. The first system shows the treble and bass staves with fingerings: Treble (2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1) and Bass (4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1). The second system continues the scale with fingerings: Treble (3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1).

F# melodic minor

Two systems of musical notation for the F# melodic minor scale. The first system shows the treble and bass staves with fingerings: Treble (2 3 1 2 3 4 1 3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1) and Bass (4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1). The second system continues the scale with fingerings: Treble (3 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1).

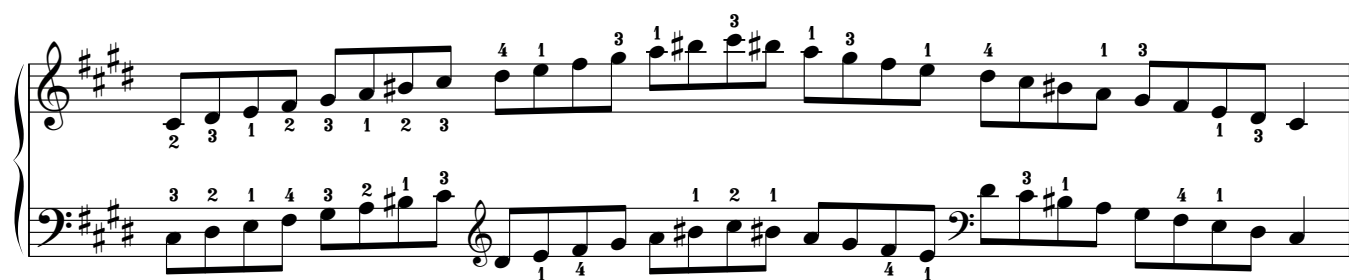
F harmonic minor

Two systems of musical notation for the F harmonic minor scale. The first system shows the treble and bass staves with fingerings: Treble (1 2 3 4 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1). The second system continues the scale with fingerings: Treble (4 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1).

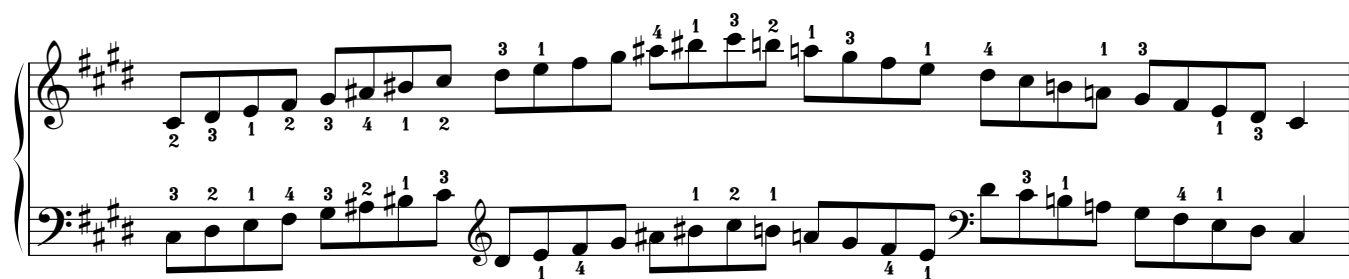
F melodic minor

Two systems of musical notation for the F melodic minor scale. The first system shows the treble and bass staves with fingerings: Treble (1 2 3 4 1 2 3 1 4 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1). The second system continues the scale with fingerings: Treble (4 1 2 3 4 5 4 3 2 1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1) and Bass (1 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1 4 3 2 1).

C# harmonic minor



C# melodic minor

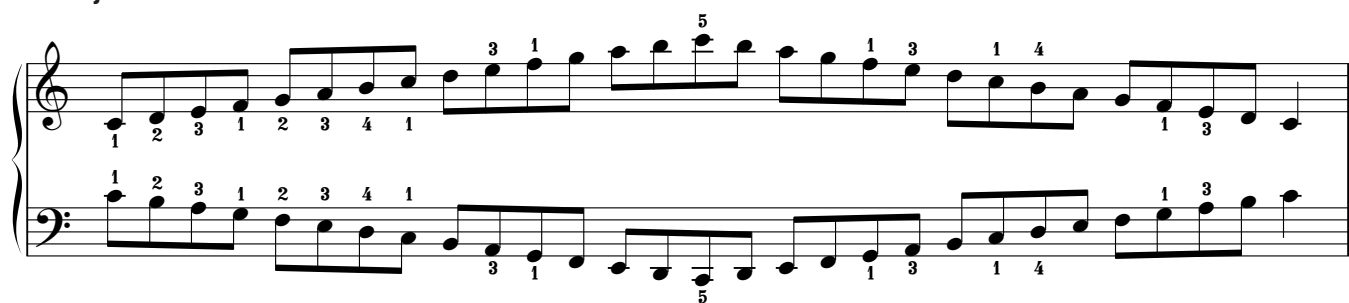


Contrary motion scales: 2 octaves

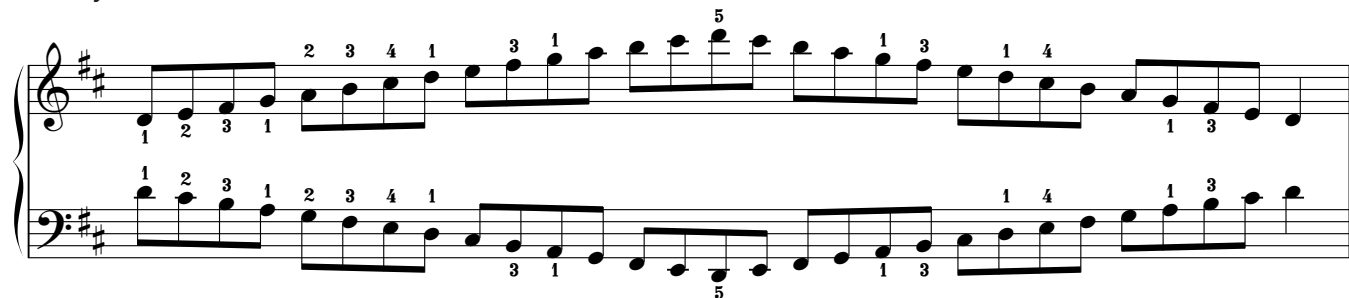
C, D, A, E, B, F#, F and D $\flat$ major
C, D, A, E, B, F#, F and C# harmonic minor

- *Piano* and *forte*, *legato* and *staccato*
- Recommended tempo: $\text{♩} = 80$

C major



D major



A major

Piano exercise for A major scale. The exercise is written for both treble and bass clefs. The treble clef starts on A4 (F#4) and the bass clef starts on A3 (F#3). The exercise consists of two octaves of the scale, ascending and descending, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The key signature has three sharps (F#, C#, G#).

E major

Piano exercise for E major scale. The exercise is written for both treble and bass clefs. The treble clef starts on E4 (D#4) and the bass clef starts on E3 (D#3). The exercise consists of two octaves of the scale, ascending and descending, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The key signature has four sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#).

B major

Piano exercise for B major scale. The exercise is written for both treble and bass clefs. The treble clef starts on B4 (A#4) and the bass clef starts on B3 (A#3). The exercise consists of two octaves of the scale, ascending and descending, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The key signature has five sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#).

F# major

Piano exercise for F# major scale. The exercise is written for both treble and bass clefs. The treble clef starts on F#4 (E#4) and the bass clef starts on F#3 (E#3). The exercise consists of two octaves of the scale, ascending and descending, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-4. The key signature has six sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#, E#).

F major

Piano exercise for F major scale. The exercise is written for both treble and bass clefs. The treble clef starts on F4 (E4) and the bass clef starts on F3 (E3). The exercise consists of two octaves of the scale, ascending and descending, with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-4. The key signature has one flat (Bb).

D $\flat$ major

Piano exercise for D $\flat$ major scale. The exercise is written for piano in D $\flat$ major (three flats). It consists of two staves, treble and bass. The right hand starts on D $\flat$ (F $\flat$) and the left hand starts on D $\flat$ (F $\flat$). The exercise is a continuous scale run with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-4. The right hand uses fingerings 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1. The left hand uses fingerings 2, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1.

C harmonic minor

Piano exercise for C harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano in C harmonic minor (no sharps or flats). It consists of two staves, treble and bass. The right hand starts on C and the left hand starts on C. The exercise is a continuous scale run with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The right hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1. The left hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1.

D harmonic minor

Piano exercise for D harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano in D harmonic minor (two flats). It consists of two staves, treble and bass. The right hand starts on D and the left hand starts on D. The exercise is a continuous scale run with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The right hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1. The left hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1.

A harmonic minor

Piano exercise for A harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano in A harmonic minor (no sharps or flats). It consists of two staves, treble and bass. The right hand starts on A and the left hand starts on A. The exercise is a continuous scale run with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The right hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1. The left hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1.

E harmonic minor

Piano exercise for E harmonic minor scale. The exercise is written for piano in E harmonic minor (one sharp). It consists of two staves, treble and bass. The right hand starts on E and the left hand starts on E. The exercise is a continuous scale run with fingerings indicated by numbers 1-5. The right hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1. The left hand uses fingerings 1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1.

B harmonic minor

Ascending: B2, C#3, D#4, E5, F#6, G#7, A8, B9. Descending: A8, G#7, F#6, E5, D#4, C#3, B2. Fingering: Ascending (1, 2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1), Descending (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4).

F# harmonic minor

Ascending: F#2, G#3, A4, B5, C#6, D#7, E8, F#9. Descending: E8, D#7, C#6, B5, A4, G#3, F#2. Fingering: Ascending (2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1), Descending (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4).

F harmonic minor

Ascending: F2, G3, A4, B5, C6, D7, E8, F9. Descending: E8, D7, C6, B5, A4, G3, F2. Fingering: Ascending (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1), Descending (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4).

C# harmonic minor

Ascending: C#2, D#3, E4, F#5, G#6, A7, B8, C#9. Descending: B8, A7, G#6, F#5, E4, D#3, C#2. Fingering: Ascending (2, 3, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 4, 1), Descending (1, 2, 3, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 2, 3, 1, 4, 1, 3, 1, 4).

Scales in thirds, hands separately:

1 octave

G and D major

- *Piano* and *forte*
- Recommended tempo: ♩ = 120

G major

(2 3 4 5 3 4 5 4 5 4 3 5 4 3 2)
 1 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 3 2 1 1

RH

3 4 5 3 4 3 4 5 4 3 4 3 5 4 3
 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 3 2 1 1

LH

2 1 2 1 3 2 1 3 2 1 3 2 1 3
 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3

D major

(2 3 4 5 3 4 5 3 5 4 3 5 4 3 2)
 1 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 3 2 1 3 2 1 1

RH

3 4 5 3 4 3 4 5 4 3 4 3 5 4 3
 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 2 3 1 3 2 1 1

LH

(3 2 1 1) (1 1 2 3)
 2 1 2 1 3 2 1 3 2 1 3 2 1 3
 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3 4 3

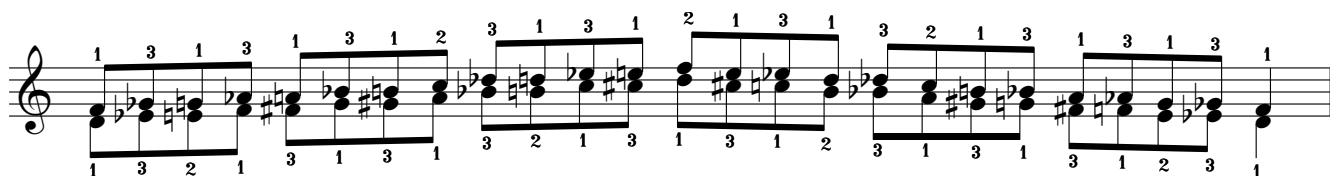
Chromatic scale in minor thirds:

2 octaves

(1 octave shown)

Hands a minor third apart, beginning on D/F

- *Piano and forte, legato and staccato*
- Recommended tempo: ♩ = 80



Contrary motion chromatic scales:

2 octaves

(1 octave shown)

In contrary motion, beginning on C and on F#

- *Piano and forte*
- Recommended tempo: ♩ = 80

Beginning on C



Beginning on F#



Arpeggios:

4 octaves

(2 octaves shown)

C, D, A, E, B, F $\sharp$, F and D $\flat$ major

C, D, A, E, B, F $\sharp$, F, and C $\sharp$ minor

- Root position and 1st inversion
- Hands separately and together
- *Piano* and *forte*
- Recommended tempo: $\text{♩} = 52$

C major

Handwritten musical notation for C major arpeggios, 4 octaves, 2 octaves shown. The notation is in treble and bass clefs, showing the sequence of notes and fingerings for the arpeggio.

C minor

Handwritten musical notation for C minor arpeggios, 4 octaves, 2 octaves shown. The notation is in treble and bass clefs, showing the sequence of notes and fingerings for the arpeggio.

D major

Handwritten musical notation for D major arpeggios, 4 octaves, 2 octaves shown. The notation is in treble and bass clefs, showing the sequence of notes and fingerings for the arpeggio.

D minor

Handwritten musical notation for D minor arpeggios, 4 octaves, 2 octaves shown. The notation is in treble and bass clefs, showing the sequence of notes and fingerings for the arpeggio.

A major

First ending: Treble clef (A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, D5, C#5, B4, A4), Bass clef (A3, G#3, F#4, E4, D4, C#4, B3, A3).
Second ending: Treble clef (A4, B4, C#5, D5, E5, D5, C#5, B4, A4), Bass clef (A3, G#3, F#4, E4, D4, C#4, B3, A3).

A minor

First ending: Treble clef (A4, B4, C5, D5, E5, D5, C5, B4, A4), Bass clef (A3, G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3).
Second ending: Treble clef (A4, B4, C5, D5, E5, D5, C5, B4, A4), Bass clef (A3, G4, F4, E4, D4, C4, B3, A3).

E major

First ending: Treble clef (E4, F#4, G#4, A5, B5, A5, G#4, F#4, E4), Bass clef (E3, D#3, C#4, B3, A3, G#3, F#3, E3).
Second ending: Treble clef (E4, F#4, G#4, A5, B5, A5, G#4, F#4, E4), Bass clef (E3, D#3, C#4, B3, A3, G#3, F#3, E3).

E minor

First ending: Treble clef (E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, A4, G4, F4, E4), Bass clef (E3, D4, C4, B3, A3, G4, F4, E4).
Second ending: Treble clef (E4, F4, G4, A4, B4, A4, G4, F4, E4), Bass clef (E3, D4, C4, B3, A3, G4, F4, E4).

B major

First ending: Treble clef (B4, C#5, D#5, E6, F#6, E6, D#5, C#5, B4), Bass clef (B3, A#3, G#4, F#4, E4, D#4, C#4, B3).
Second ending: Treble clef (B4, C#5, D#5, E6, F#6, E6, D#5, C#5, B4), Bass clef (B3, A#3, G#4, F#4, E4, D#4, C#4, B3).

B minor

Handwritten musical score for B minor, measures 1-4. The score is written for piano (p) and includes fingerings. The key signature has two sharps (F# and C#). The melody in the right hand starts on B4 and moves up stepwise to G#5, then descends. The bass line in the left hand starts on B2 and moves up stepwise to G#3, then descends. The first measure is marked with a '4' below the bass line, indicating a four-measure rest.

F# major

Handwritten musical score for F# major, measures 1-4. The key signature has three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The melody in the right hand starts on F#4 and moves up stepwise to D#5, then descends. The bass line in the left hand starts on F#2 and moves up stepwise to D#3, then descends. The first measure is marked with a '5' below the bass line, indicating a five-measure rest.

F# minor

Handwritten musical score for F# minor, measures 1-4. The key signature has three sharps (F#, C#, G#). The melody in the right hand starts on F#4 and moves up stepwise to D#5, then descends. The bass line in the left hand starts on F#2 and moves up stepwise to D#3, then descends. The first measure is marked with a '3' below the bass line, indicating a three-measure rest.

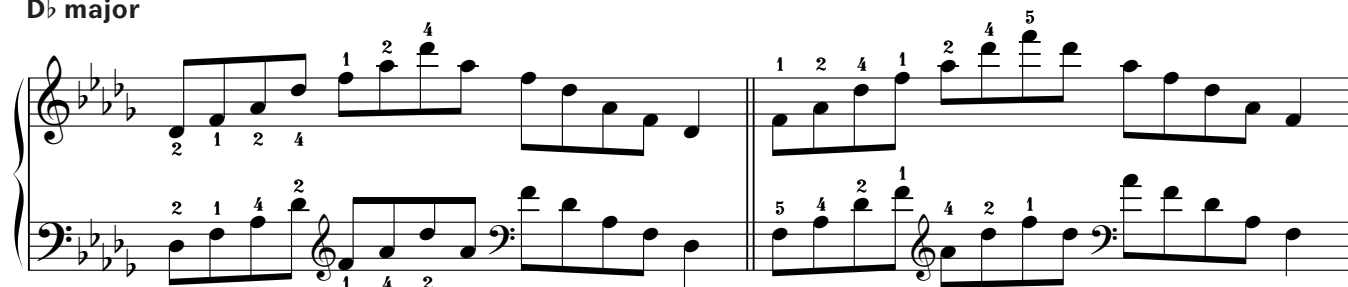
F major

Handwritten musical score for F major, measures 1-4. The key signature has one flat (Bb). The melody in the right hand starts on F4 and moves up stepwise to D5, then descends. The bass line in the left hand starts on F2 and moves up stepwise to D3, then descends. The first measure is marked with a '5' below the bass line, indicating a five-measure rest.

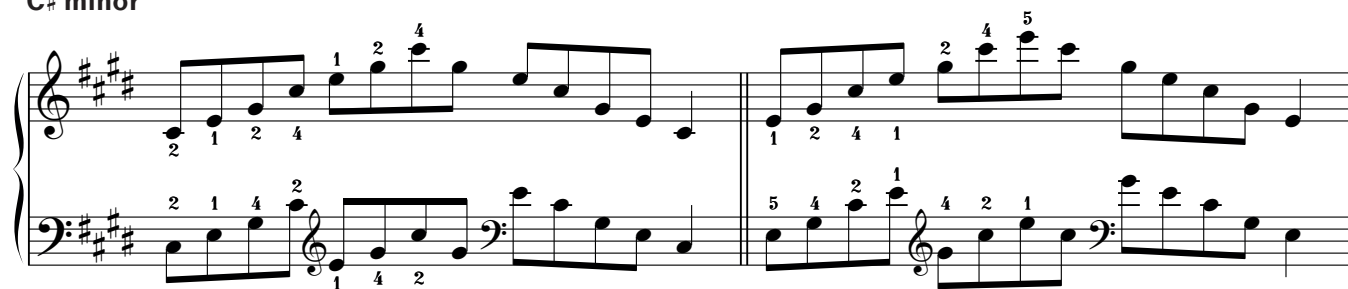
F minor

Handwritten musical score for F minor, measures 1-4. The key signature has two flats (Bb and Eb). The melody in the right hand starts on F4 and moves up stepwise to D5, then descends. The bass line in the left hand starts on F2 and moves up stepwise to D3, then descends. The first measure is marked with a '5' below the bass line, indicating a five-measure rest.

D $\flat$ major



C $\sharp$ minor

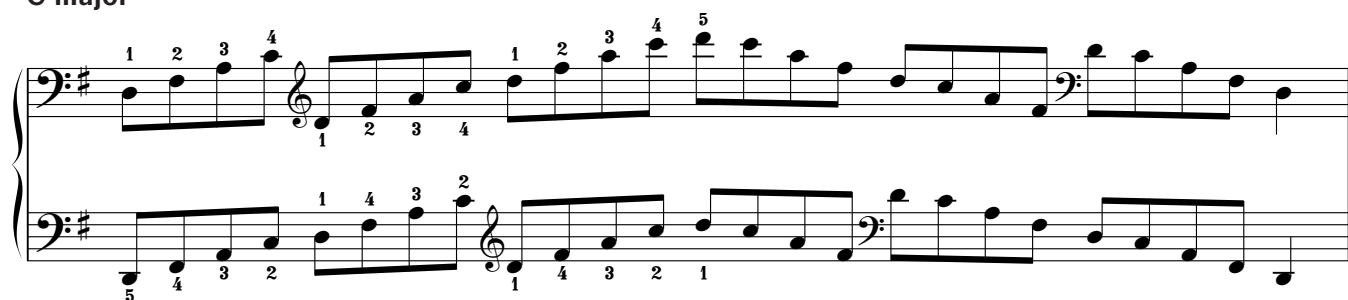


Dominant 7th arpeggios: 3 octaves

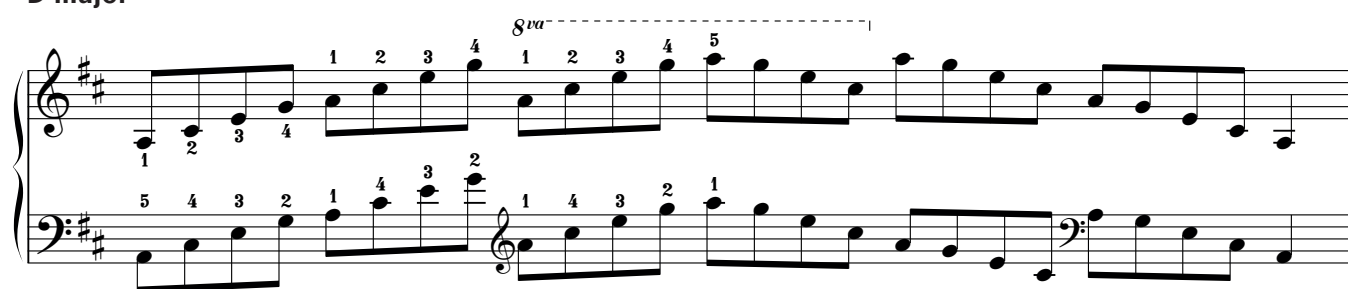
In the keys of G, D, A, E, B and F major

- Hands separately and together
- *Piano* and *forte*
- Recommended tempo: $\text{♩} = 52$

G major



D major



A major

8va

Handwritten musical score for the A major scale in bass clef. The score is written on two staves. The first staff contains the ascending scale (A1 to A4) with fingerings 1-2-3-4, 1-2-3-4, and 1-2-3-4-5. The second staff contains the descending scale (A4 to A1) with fingerings 5-4-3-2, 1-4-3-2, and 1-4-3-2. The key signature has three sharps (F#, C#, G#).

E major

8va

Handwritten musical score for the E major scale in treble clef. The score is written on two staves. The first staff contains the ascending scale (E4 to E7) with fingerings 1-2-3-4, 1-2-3-4-5, and 1-2-3-4-5. The second staff contains the descending scale (E7 to E4) with fingerings 5-4-3-2, 1-4-3-2, and 1-4-3-2. The key signature has four sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#).

B major

Handwritten musical score for the B major scale in treble clef. The score is written on two staves. The first staff contains the ascending scale (B4 to B7) with fingerings 2-3-4-1, 2-3-4-1, and 2-3-4-1-2. The second staff contains the descending scale (B7 to B4) with fingerings 4-3-2-1, 4-3-2-1, and 4-3-2-1. The key signature has five sharps (F#, C#, G#, D#, A#).

F major

8va

Handwritten musical score for the F major scale in treble clef. The score is written on two staves. The first staff contains the ascending scale (F4 to F7) with fingerings 1-2-3-4, 1-2-3-4-5, and 1-2-3-4-5. The second staff contains the descending scale (F7 to F4) with fingerings 5-4-3-2, 1-4-3-2, and 1-4-3-2. The key signature has one flat (Bb).

Diminished 7th arpeggios: 3 octaves

Beginning on C[#], D and E^b

- Hands separately and together
- *Piano* and *forte*
- Recommended tempo: ♩ = 52

Beginning on C[#]

Handwritten musical score for diminished 7th arpeggios starting on C[#]. The score is written for piano, with treble and bass staves. The key signature has one sharp (F[#]). The tempo is marked as 8va. The score includes fingerings (1-4) and articulation marks (accents) for each note. The arpeggio is played in both hands, with the right hand starting on C[#] and the left hand starting on F[#]. The pattern is repeated three times, each time moving up an octave.

Beginning on D

Handwritten musical score for diminished 7th arpeggios starting on D. The score is written for piano, with treble and bass staves. The key signature has two sharps (F[#], C[#]). The tempo is marked as 8va. The score includes fingerings (1-4) and articulation marks (accents) for each note. The arpeggio is played in both hands, with the right hand starting on D and the left hand starting on B[#]. The pattern is repeated three times, each time moving up an octave.

Beginning on E^b

Handwritten musical score for diminished 7th arpeggios starting on E^b. The score is written for piano, with treble and bass staves. The key signature has three flats (B^b, E^b, A^b). The tempo is marked as 8va. The score includes fingerings (1-4) and articulation marks (accents) for each note. The arpeggio is played in both hands, with the right hand starting on E^b and the left hand starting on B^b. The pattern is repeated three times, each time moving up an octave.

15

16

4-5

19

ff

8

22

25

8

28

31

2

Etude in E, Op. 47 No. 16

Stephen Heller

Andantino ♩ = 84

p

p

p

p

rit.

p

15 **a tempo**

Measures 15-18. Treble clef: Melody with eighth and sixteenth notes, some beamed. Bass clef: Steady eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p* (piano), accents.

19 **rit. a tempo**

Measures 19-22. Treble clef: Melody with triplets and slurs. Bass clef: Steady eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p* (piano), *pp* (pianissimo).

23

Measures 23-26. Treble clef: Melody with slurs and accents. Bass clef: Steady eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p* (piano).

27 **rit. a tempo**

Measures 27-30. Treble clef: Melody with slurs and accents. Bass clef: Steady eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p* (piano).

30 **rit.**

Measures 30-33. Treble clef: Melody with slurs and accents. Bass clef: Steady eighth-note accompaniment. Dynamics: *p* (piano), *pp* (pianissimo).

Fantasia in C

George Frideric Handel

HWV 490

About

Handel represents one of the pinnacles of Baroque music; he was the greatest composer of opera and oratorio of his time.

By the age of 18 he was already a church organist in his home town of Halle, but his musical ambitions soon led him to move on. First to Hamburg, where he wrote his first operatic works, then to Italy in 1706, where he wrote his first Italian opera, *Rodrigo* (1707).

In 1710 he moved to England, which would become his permanent home. For the majority of his career he composed music in the Italian Baroque style, but by 1741, when Italian opera was fast going out of fashion in England, Handel gave up writing operas and focused primarily on English language choral works.

Many of his most popular works date from this period, including the oratorios *Messiah* (1741) and *Solomon* (1749), and the suite for wind ensemble, *Music for the Royal Fireworks* (1749).

In performance

In addition to being a prolific composer of opera and oratorio, Handel was a formidable organ and harpsichord virtuoso, as this resonant Fantasia proves. The tempo can be dictated by the triplet semiquavers (bars 14–15 and 54–55), which should be brilliant and clear; this will allow for sufficient forward thrust without anything being garbled.

Within any semiquaver passages try to look for latent melodic properties (for example the right hand lower notes in bars 8 and 9) so the passages don't sound too 'notey'. At bar 37 the texture is thick, so try to lighten where you can by not crashing the left hand octaves and by emphasising the right hand's rising chromatics on the main beats. Take particular care at bar 42, where it is difficult to avoid the lower voice 'lumpening' the upper voice. From the scales in bar 44 to the return of the opening material in bar 48 you can play freely in the style of a cadenza if you wish.

(Daniel Grimwood)

Fantasia in C

George Frideric Handel
(1685–1759)

[♩ = ca. 92–104]

The musical score for the first system (measures 1-3) is in common time (C). The treble clef staff begins with a quarter rest, followed by eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1). The bass clef staff has a quarter rest, followed by chords (4, 5), a quarter rest, and chords (4, 5). Measure 2 features eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 3 has eighth-note pairs (1, 2) and a quarter rest (2) in the treble, and chords (5, 4) and a quarter rest in the bass. The second system (measures 4-6) continues with eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 5 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 6 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. The third system (measures 7-9) features eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 8 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 9 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. The fourth system (measures 10-12) features eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 11 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 12 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. The fifth system (measures 13-15) features eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 14 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass. Measure 15 has eighth-note pairs (2, 1) and a quarter rest (1) in the treble, and chords (4, 5) and a quarter rest in the bass.

16

19

21

(23)

27

30

33

36

38

40

42

44

46

49

52

55

58

61

Minuet in D

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart

K. 355/576b

About

Very little is known about Mozart's Minuet in D; exactly when and where it was composed is unclear, although it is believed to have been written around 1789, a difficult period in Mozart's life.

He had married his wife Constanze in 1782, and between 1783 and 1789 they had five children, only one of which survived infancy. This period was also marred by financial troubles and Mozart would frequently borrow money from his friends to maintain the lifestyle he was used to.

The Minuet was published in 1801, ten years after Mozart's death; published with a Trio composed by Maximilian Stadler, who possibly also completed the Minuet itself. A monk, musicologist, composer and prominent figure in Vienna's music scene at the time, Stadler was a friend of Mozart's, who wrote several essays on his music and completed a number of Mozart's unfinished works after his death.

In performance

The tempo should be no quicker than the extraordinary and experimental harmonies allow. The piece presents challenges in balancing the tortured chromaticisms against the rather cheerful codas to each half; and the fact that this is, in name at least, a dance.

The clarity of the counterpoint suggests string quartet writing, and I would recommend listening to Mozart's late quartets as part of your preparation, as the articulation should resemble that of a string player. The turns can either be executed between the dotted quaver and semiquaver, or on the main beat, starting on the upper note. The alternating *f* and *p* markings starting at bar 5 probably shouldn't be extreme, possibly *subito f* followed by a *diminuendo* to each *p* would work well. In bars 20 to 23 make sure the right hand sounds like two distinct instruments. In general I would recommend practising the voices separately, as you would with a fugue.

(Daniel Grimwood)

Minuet in D

Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart
(1756–1791)

[♩ = ca. 84–88]

The musical score for the Minuet in D by Wolfgang Amadeus Mozart is presented in five systems, each with a treble and bass staff joined by a brace. The key signature is D major (two sharps) and the time signature is 3/4. The tempo is indicated as [♩ = ca. 84–88].

System 1 (Measures 1-5): Measure 1 starts with a *dolce* marking. Measure 3 features a triplet of eighth notes in the treble. Measure 5 ends with a *f* marking and a fermata over a half note.

System 2 (Measures 6-11): Measures 6 and 8 are marked *p*. Measures 7 and 9 are marked *f*. Measures 10 and 11 are marked *p*. Measure 11 ends with a *f* marking and a fermata over a half note.

System 3 (Measures 12-16): Measure 12 is marked *p*. Measures 13, 14, 15, and 16 contain eighth-note patterns with various fingerings (1, 2, 3, 4, 5) indicated above the notes.

System 4 (Measures 17-20): Measure 17 is marked *f*. Measures 18, 19, and 20 contain eighth-note patterns with fingerings (1, 2, 3, 4, 5) indicated above the notes.

System 5 (Measures 21-24): Measures 21, 22, 23, and 24 contain eighth-note patterns with fingerings (1, 2, 3, 4, 5) indicated above the notes.

24

27

mancando

dolce

31

f

p

f

p

36

p

f

p

f

p

40

p

Juli

Fanny Mendelssohn

from *Das Jahr*

About

Taught to play the piano by her mother, Fanny Mendelssohn was an accomplished pianist from a young age; by the age of 14 she was able to play the first book of Bach's *The Well-Tempered Clavier* from memory.

Despite writing her own music as a teenager, the misogynistic attitudes towards women at the time — shared by her father and her brother — made it impossible for her to publish under her own name. In spite of this her love for music prevailed and she wrote over 460 works during her short life, including the large-scale cycle, *Das Jahr*, a truly multimedia composition incorporating poetry, and drawings by her husband, Wilhelm Hensel, alongside the music.

She finally defied her brother and published a collection of songs under her own name in 1846 (as her Op. 1); sadly she died suddenly the following year of a stroke, only 41 years old.

In performance

Fanny Mendelssohn's large-scale and virtuosic *Das Jahr* forms a diary of a year spent travelling around Italy, rather like Liszt's *Années de pèlerinage*. *Juli* is evocative of the oppressive heat of an Italian summer, with its doom-ridden melody and rumbles of thunder in the low bass.

The shifting chromatics in the major key section which opens the piece should create a sense of expectation. At the start of the *minore* (bar 17) darken the sound by allowing the left hand melody to sing out—you can use the repeated chords to add swells to each of these phrases, building in intensity each time.

At bar 25 keep the tremolos as quiet as possible. From bar 37 think of the detached semiquavers as the first heavy raindrops as the storm starts to near, but make sure they don't obscure the melody and, where possible, keep them free of pedal.

(Daniel Grimwood)

Juli

from *Das Jahr*

Fanny Mendelssohn
(1805–1847)

Larghetto [♩ = ca. 52–58]

The musical score for 'Juli' is presented in five systems, each with a grand staff (treble and bass clefs). The key signature is B-flat major (two flats). The time signature is 2/4.

- System 1 (Measures 1-5):** The melody in the treble clef features a half note G4, a quarter note A4, and a half note B4, all tied across measures. The bass clef provides a simple harmonic accompaniment. Dynamics include *p* and *< >*. Fingering numbers 3, 2-5, and 4/2 are indicated.
- System 2 (Measures 6-11):** The melody continues with a half note B4, a quarter note C5, and a half note D5. The bass clef accompaniment is more active. Dynamics include *pp*. Fingering numbers 2-3 and 3-5 are indicated.
- System 3 (Measures 12-16):** The melody features a half note E5, a quarter note F5, and a half note G5. The bass clef accompaniment is more active. Dynamics include *p*. A tempo change is indicated by [♩ = ♩.] and a key change to C major (no sharps or flats) is shown at the end of the system.
- System 4 (Measures 17-20):** The melody features a half note A5, a quarter note B5, and a half note C6. The bass clef accompaniment is more active. Dynamics include *mp*. Fingering numbers 4, 1, 2, 1, 1, 2, and 5 are indicated.
- System 5 (Measures 21-24):** The melody features a half note D6, a quarter note E6, and a half note F6. The bass clef accompaniment is more active. Dynamics include *mf*. Fingering numbers 2, 1, 1, 2, 4, and 5 are indicated.

25

pp
tremolo
5
8vb

27

mp
cresc.
5
8vb

29

f
dim.
5
8vb

31

p
tremolo
5
8vb

34

poco rit.
pp
5
8vb

a tempo

37

p < > *p* *stacc. simile*

41

mf *p*

45

mf *cresc.* *cresc.*

49

poco rit.

f *mf*

53 [a tempo]

ff *p* *p*

5

8^{vb}

57

62

cresc.

66

p

70

con espress. *pp*

D'un jardin clair

Lili Boulanger

About

Lili Boulanger's short life was filled with music from the beginning; her mother was a singer, her father a composer and a number of the extended family were professional musicians. It is no wonder that growing up in this musical environment Lili developed a prodigious talent for music early on.

In 1913, aged 19, she became the first woman to win the prestigious Prix de Rome composition prize with her cantata *Faust et Hélène* — part of her award would have been a two-year scholarship studying at the Villa Medici in Rome but due to illness and the breakout of WW1 she was only able to spend a few months there. *D'un jardin clair* was written during this period.

Her early works show the influences of Debussy, and her friend and teacher Gabriel Fauré, however, as her life was cut tragically short aged 24 due to illness, it is impossible to say how her style may have evolved.

In performance

It is tempting to play this very slowly from the beginning, so pay attention to the *Assez vite* tempo marking (rather quick). Obeying the composer's very detailed markings to the letter will create an impression of improvisation, without needing to add much extra. Allow the instructions like *léger*, *souple* and *fluide* to inform your interpretation.

Be aware of the contours of the phrases — some arch, some rise, some fall, and they should all feel different. Great subtlety of balance, articulation, rhythm and pedalling will be needed.

In general I feel the melody should emerge from a haze of harmony rather than be accentuated, and that the notes in both the *staccato* and the slurred chords should be evenly voiced. From bar 36 take enough time over the left hand grace notes so that they don't sound snatched, and make sure that the pedal holds on the bass notes through the bars.

(Daniel Grimwood)

D'un jardin clair

Lili Boulanger
(1893–1918)

Assez vite [♩ = ca. 132–152] *animez un peu*

p léger

rit.

a tempo

p

mf

pp

a tempo

rit.

mf souple

p

21

mf *pp* *f*

26

p *mf*

moins vite que le début

30

pp *p*

35

cresc. *dim.* *8va* *cédez*

40

plus lent
(bien chanté)

p *pp fluide* *mp*

8^{va} 8^{vb} 2^{ed}

45

pp *mf* *pp*

8^{vb}
* Red.

50

mf *pp*

8^{va}
8^{vb}
* Red.

54

rit.

pp (clair)

8^{va}
pp

8^{vb}
* Red.

en dehors, mais doux

58

ppp

8^{vb} 8^{vb} 8^{vb}

Waltz in E minor

César Cui

Op. 31 No. 2

About

Cesar Cui was a Russian composer and music critic, known for his role in a group of composers working to create an authentically Russian style of music, often referred to as The Five.

Cui wrote some short pieces as a teenager, but his interest in music grew in 1856 when he met composer Mily Balakirev and became involved with his mission to create and promote Russian music. Despite being part of The Five, Cui's own music was probably the least nationalistic of the group and he rarely directly used Russian sources.

In addition to being a prolific composer, Cui also wrote around 800 articles as a music critic for various newspapers, while holding down a 'day job' as a military engineer and professor. An expert on military fortifications, he rose to the rank of Engineer-General in the Imperial Russian Army, writing several books which were widely used at the time.

In performance

From the outset there is an unsettled feel, and a tension between the forward volition of the harmony and the poignant dissonance of the fragmented melodic line, one pushing against the other. With this in mind, allow the melody to pull the piece back to an *allegretto* rather than the harmony pushing it toward an *allegro*.

Take great care that the accompaniment doesn't obscure the melody and that the pedalling is clean. At bar 17, the first *mf*, the melody inverts and has no dynamic hairpin — you might want to take time here.

The character sweetens at bar 27 and, as you bring out the countermelody in the left hand the tempo may need to broaden to accommodate the duet. The *poco accel.* into bar 46 must cascade dramatically, and notice there is no *diminuendo*, so *subito p* after the *rit.*

In bars 64 to 67 make sure the quavers are a lower dynamic than the chords. Don't *rallentando* before Cui indicates in the penultimate bar.

(Daniel Grimwood)

Waltz in E minor

César Cui
(1835–1918)

Allegretto $\text{♩} = 54$

The musical score is written for piano in E minor, 3/4 time. It consists of five systems of staves, each with a treble and bass clef. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The tempo is marked 'Allegretto' with a quarter note equal to 54 beats per minute. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and fingering numbers (1-5). Dynamics include *p* (piano), *cresc.* (crescendo), *mf* (mezzo-forte), *poco rit.* (a little slower), and *a tempo*. The piece concludes with a final cadence marked 'LH' and a fermata.

Measures 1-5: *p* (piano). Measures 6-10: Measure 6 starts with a treble clef change. Measures 11-15: Measure 14 includes a *cresc.* marking. Measures 16-20: Measure 16 starts with a *mf* marking. Measures 21-25: Measures 23-24 are marked *poco rit.*, and measure 25 is marked *a tempo*. The piece ends with a final cadence marked 'LH' and a fermata.

27

p

2 1 3 5 1

32

3 5 3

37

p

42

pp

poco accel.

LH 1 2 4 *f*

47

rit.

a tempo

p

2

52

57

cresc.

62

mf

4-5

67

f

5

73

p

p

p

7

79

2

4

pp

85

rall.

8va-

2

Waltz in G minor

Maurice Ravel

No. 2 from *Valses nobles et sentimentales*

About

Directly inspired by the collections of *Valses nobles* (1825) and *Valses sentimentales* (1827) written by Franz Schubert, Ravel's *Valses nobles et sentimentales* was first performed in 1911 by Louis Aubert, to whom Ravel dedicated the pieces. At the premiere, the suite was performed without the audience knowing the identity of the composer. A vote afterwards confirmed the majority believed Ravel to be the author but during the performance a number of people apparently laughed and talked over the music.

Ravel frequently orchestrated his own piano works, and the following year his orchestral version, written to accompany a ballet, received a more positive premiere — the richness of the orchestral colour softening some of the dissonances and stark textures of the original.

In performance

Ravel said that in his *Valses nobles et sentimentales* he was occupied with a 'style that is simpler and clearer, in which the harmony is harder and the lines of the music are made to show up'. The harmonies in this, the second waltz of the suite, are indeed hard-edged although the second melody (from bar 9) reminds us of Satie.

The pianist Perlemuter, who knew Ravel and studied this music with him, has related that the dynamic hairpins could never be emphasised enough. Notice that bars 2, 18 and 53 don't give a new dynamic, which suggests one strong bar followed by a weak bar.

Ravel recorded a piano roll of them; I would recommend listening to this, and his orchestral arrangement of the waltzes, to inform your interpretative choices.

(Daniel Grimwood)

Waltz in G minor

No. 2 from *Valses nobles et sentimentales*

Maurice Ravel
(1875–1937)

Assez lent ♩ = 104
avec une expression intense

The musical score is written for piano and consists of 52 measures. It is in G minor (three flats) and 3/4 time. The tempo is marked 'Assez lent' with a metronome marking of 104. The performance instruction is 'avec une expression intense'. The score is divided into several systems, each with a measure number at the beginning. The first system (measures 1-6) includes the instruction 'en dehors' and a piano dynamic 'p'. The second system (measures 7-12) includes 'rit.' and 'a tempo doux et expressif' with a pianissimo dynamic 'pp'. The third system (measures 13-18) includes a mezzo-forte dynamic 'mf'. The fourth system (measures 19-24) includes a rallentando 'rall.' and a piano dynamic 'p'. The fifth system (measures 25-30) includes 'au mouvt. (un peu plus lent et rubato)' and a pianissimo dynamic 'pp'. The final system (measures 31-52) includes an 'expressif' instruction and a piano dynamic 'p'. The score features various musical notations including chords, arpeggios, and melodic lines in both hands.

52

rit. Tempo 1

30 *mf* très expressif

36 *pp* un peu en dehors mystérieux

42

48 *f* très expressif

54 *p* *pp* rall. au mouvt. (rubato)

59 *p* expressif rall.

Red. *

Tribute to Roberto García Morillo Alberto Ginastera

from *12 American Preludes*

About

Born in Argentina to an Italian mother and Catalan father, Alberto Ginastera is one of the most significant composers of the twentieth century. He is known for mixing the rhythms and sounds of Argentinian folk music with traditions and innovations of European and American music of his time.

His early pieces often draw directly on Argentinian folk music, whereas his compositions in the late 1940s and 50s saw him using folk themes in a more abstract way. From the late 1950s until his death in 1983, Ginastera described his work as ‘neo-expressionist’, a style often characterised by intense subjectivity and rough handling of materials. The *12 American Preludes* date from near the end of his first period, and contain four musical tributes, including this — for his fellow Argentinian composer Roberto García Morillo.

In performance

Tribute to Roberto García Morillo is a toccata full of Latin fire, with a constant drumming pattern between the hands alternating with a grand gesture; the right hand sweeping up and down in arpeggios while the left hand descends in a syncopated rumba dance rhythm.

Towards the end, these drumming chords expand into wider and wider clusters, as though many other drummers are joining in, resulting in a thrilling *crescendo* — be sure to pace the dynamics to leave enough room to get to the loudest point at the end.

Although there is a temptation to play as fast as possible, a tempo that allows clear articulation, evenness of articulation and power will result in a more exciting performance.

(Zubin Kanga)

“Homenaje a Roberto García Morillo” from “12 American Preludes”
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Tribute to Roberto García Morillo

from *12 American Preludes*

Alberto Ginastera
(1916–1983)

Presto [♩ = ca. 138–160]

6

marcato

11

16

22

28

28

34 *sempre f*

34

40

40

45 *cresc. molto*

45

50

50

55 *ff sempre fff*

55

Lowside Blues

Joanna MacGregor

About

As a child Joanna MacGregor was taught to play music by her mother and was drawn to the great variety of styles it was possible to play on the piano — together with her mother she would play everything from Bach to the Beatles.

She studied music at Cambridge and then at the Royal Academy of Music; in her early twenties she was taken on by the Young Concert Artist Trust, a charity that provides guidance and management for emerging musicians. MacGregor has gone on to become one of the world's most innovative musicians — concert pianist, conductor, artistic director and composer. She is known for the eclectic range of music that she performs and the range of musicians and artists she collaborates with. Since 2011 she has been Head of Piano at the Royal Academy of Music in London.

In performance

Lowside Blues draws together blues and jazz styles with classical techniques. The left hand plays an ostinato that resembles a double bass, with the right hand playing the roles of both accompaniment and melody.

There are many blues elements in the work, including 'blue notes' that imitate the way blues singers bend their pitch for deeper expressivity. Later in the piece the chromatic grace notes imitate another bluesy effect, sliding in pitch, and these sound like a trumpet or saxophone in the blues band.

There are several unusual techniques to enjoy, including stomping the foot on the ground, and the long, exciting glissando up the piano. Maintaining the groove is important, with the accents in the bassline creating jazzy syncopations. The right hand melody needs to be played with a lot of flair and raw emotion.

(Zubin Kanga)

Lowside Blues

Joanna MacGregor

Unhurried ♩ = 116

mf
left hand prominent, swagger

p $\frac{5}{2}$
1

2

5

mf

9 (3+3+2) *sing*
f *mp*
Right heel *p*

13 *sim.* 1 4 5 1

17 (3+2+3) *mf* *f*
Right heel

21 *p* detached, playful *spiky*

24

27

30 *ff* *Free* *gliss.* 8va-1* *a tempo* *sfp* *Red.* *

33 *f* *p* *sfp* *f* *p* *slightly hesitant* *Red.* *

Free, dreamlike, rapid *a tempo* *senza rit.* *pp* *pp* *growing* *Red.* *8vb*

* White note glissando, not fast but very smooth.

Bloodroot

Rachel Grimes

from *Book of Leaves*

About

Rachel Grimes is a pianist, composer and arranger from Louisville, Kentucky. She began playing the piano as soon as she could sit on the bench with her father or her grandmother, learning by ear until beginning lessons in the first grade. She joined her first band in high school and after graduating from college with a degree in music composition went on to release many albums including *The Clearing* and *Book of Leaves*. Widely known for her role in the groundbreaking chamber ensemble Rachel's, (six albums on Quarterstick/Touch and Go), she has since toured the US, Europe and Asia as a solo pianist and as a collaborator with many other artists. She scores for film and multimedia installations and creates commissioned pieces for chamber ensembles and orchestras.

Book of Leaves began as improvisations during a spring retreat at the Loretto Motherhouse in Nerinx, Kentucky. Originally written for solo piano, Grimes has subsequently arranged selected works for various chamber ensembles and for full orchestra.

In performance

Book of Leaves delves into the intimate experience of life in close proximity with the natural world and explores contrasting timeframes, environments, moods and tone colours. Personal history, memory, imaginings of the stories of those who have been here and now are gone, a quiet place unknown to us but nearby, and the vast and cyclical contexts of nature all play a part in the inspiration for this music.

Bloodroot, inspired by Bach preludes, opens with freely played arpeggios, then moves into a descending chordal theme with the right hand flowing in steady semiquavers. The pianist should aim for 2-bar phrases, gaining in intensity until the *rit.* in bar 27. Ideally the first of the semiquavers in the first and third beat of the right hand figures should speak a bit longer — voice them as the top notes of a chord, made together with the left hand. When the mood shifts in bar 29 to a more personal and melodic tone, give focus to the top voice in the right hand.

(Rachel Grimes)

Bloodroot

from *Book of Leaves*

Rachel Grimes

Take time for phrases, with rubato

mf

LH RH

rit.

f

Regular ♩ = 96

Ped. sim.

1 2 1 3 4 5

17

20

23

26

29 Subito — with suspended weight $\text{♩} = 76$

35

41

mp

mf

rit.

rubato

p

DISCUSSION

REQUIREMENTS

- Short discussion with the examiner

This part of the exam provides an opportunity to communicate your understanding and interpretation of the pieces performed, and your knowledge of musical fundamentals.

The examiner will ask questions about the pieces performed in the exam. They will be looking for you to speak with confidence and to be able to clearly articulate your answers, using appropriate vocabulary. The examiner will also ask questions about your knowledge and understanding of musical fundamentals.

The following page contains examples of the type of questions which may be asked at Grade 7. The current syllabus should be consulted for the full list of the requirements at this grade.

Sample questions

- What can you tell me about how you learned this piece?
- How do you think your performance of this piece went today?
- Why did you choose to interpret the piece in this manner?
- What do you know about the composer of this piece?
- What is the historical and stylistic context of this piece?
- What is the technical term for the musical device in this bar?
- What is the cadence in this bar?
- Can you describe the form and main keys of this piece?

SIGHT READING

REQUIREMENTS

- Performance of a short, previously unseen piece of music

One minute of preparation time will be given, during which you may study and try out parts of the test before performance.

The following are examples of the style and standard of Grade 7 sight reading tests.

Example 1

Scherzando ♩ = 60

p

sempre p

cresc.

p

Example 2

Allegro ♩ = 88

Example 2 is a musical score in 4/4 time, key of D major (indicated by two sharps). The tempo is Allegro, with a quarter note equal to 88 beats per minute. The score is written for piano and violin. The piano part begins with a forte (*f*) dynamic. The violin part features a trill in the final measure of the second system.

Example 3

Lento e espressivo ♩ = 40

Example 3 is a musical score in 6/8 time, key of B-flat major (indicated by two flats). The tempo is Lento e espressivo, with a quarter note equal to 40 beats per minute. The score is written for piano and violin. The piano part includes dynamics such as piano (*p*), mezzo-forte (*mf*), and pianissimo (*pp*), along with crescendos and decrescendos. The violin part includes a decrescendo and a final measure with a decrescendo and a fermata.

AURAL TESTS

REQUIREMENTS

- Test 1
- Test 2

These aural tests are designed to assess your listening ability and musicianship.

The following are examples of Grade 7 aural tests.

Test 1

- a) A short harmonised passage will be played. You will then be asked a selection of the questions below:
- to identify the time signature
 - to identify whether the passage is in a major or minor key
 - to describe the overall dynamics
 - to describe the basic overall form (either AB, ABA, AAB, ABAB or AABA)

Andantino

1

p *cresc.* *f*

2^{da}

poco rit.

a tempo

p *dim.* *pp*

[Form: ABA]

Andante con espressivo

2

mp *cresc.*

f *mf*

mp **rit.** **a tempo** *p*

[Form: ABA or AA'A]

Allegretto

3

p

cresc.

sub. p

f

poco rit.

a tempo

p

f

[Form: AABA or AABA']

(Test 1)

- b) You will be given a copy of the score for the passage played in Test 1a; without phrasing, tempo, articulation or dynamic markings.

The passage will be played once again in full; further shorter sections may also be played again. You will be asked a selection of the questions below:

- to suggest an appropriate tempo marking
- to describe changes in tempo
- to name the key
- to describe phrasing patterns
- to describe dynamics
- to describe articulation
- to identify modulations
- to identify ornaments
- to confirm your description of the form from Test 1a

Candidate copies are available as free downloads from the LCM Examinations website.

Test 2

The key-chord of a major or minor key will be played, followed by a short harmonised passage in the same key. The passage will finish with a harmonised cadence in the home key. You will be asked to identify the cadence as either perfect, imperfect, plagal or interrupted.

The test will then be repeated using a different example.

1

Perfect Imperfect Interrupted Plagal

2

Perfect Imperfect Interrupted Plagal

3

Perfect Imperfect Interrupted Plagal

4

Perfect Imperfect Interrupted Plagal

The image displays four musical examples, numbered 1 through 4, each illustrating a different type of cadence. Each example consists of a key-chord, a short harmonised passage, and a final cadence. The cadences are labeled as Perfect, Imperfect, Interrupted, or Plagal. Example 1 is in C major (6/8 time), Example 2 is in B-flat major (4/4 time), Example 3 is in B-flat major (4/4 time), and Example 4 is in D major (3/4 time).

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